

Notes on $c=1$ /Liouville theory

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ABSTRACT: ...

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1 Continuum theory

1.1 From the sigma model to the gauge fixed action.

We consider a free scalar coupled to two-dimensional Euclidean gravity, with a cosmological constant and a topological Einstein term on a smooth, compact two dimensional manifold $\mathcal{M}_h$ with genus h and metric g .

$$\mathcal{S}_\sigma^{(h,g,\Phi_0)} = \frac{1}{4\pi} \int_{\mathcal{M}_h} d^2x \sqrt{g} (g^{\mu\nu} \partial_\mu X \partial_\nu X + \Phi_0 \mathcal{R} + 4\pi\mu) . \quad (1.1)$$

Φ_0 is a constant and as we will see later is connected to the constant part of the linear dilaton background. The Gauss-Bonnet theorem states that $\frac{1}{4\pi} \int d^2x \sqrt{g} \mathcal{R}$ is a topological number known as the Euler characteristic $\chi_h = 2 - 2h$. The partition function is defined through the path-integral over all possible metrics on $\mathcal{M}_h$ modulo Diffeomorphism and the boson X

$$\mathcal{Z} = \sum_{h \geq 0} (g_0)^{-\chi_h} \int \frac{[Dg_{\mu\nu}^{(h)}]}{\text{Vol}(\text{Diffeo})} [DX] e^{-\mathcal{S}_\sigma^{(h,g)}} , \quad (1.2)$$

where we introduced the notation $g_0 = e^{\Phi_0}$. Note that we remove the Φ_0 from $\mathcal{S}^{(\sigma,h,\Phi_0)}$ since we have extracted the topological dependent factor from the action. We can gauge fix the metric to the fiducial metric $g_{\mu\nu} = e^{2b\phi} \hat{g}_{\mu\nu}^{(\tau)}$. The price to pay is the introduction of b, c ghost fields. The measure is not invariant under the previous map. Also, the cosmological constant term yields a non trivial ϕ dependence (because of the cc term, even classically Weyl symmetry is broken). Combined together, they yield the Liouville action

$$\mathcal{S}_L^{(\hat{g}_h)} = \frac{1}{4\pi} \int d^2x \sqrt{\hat{g}_h} \left(\hat{g}_h^{\mu\nu} \partial_\mu \phi \partial_\nu \phi + Q \hat{\mathcal{R}} \phi + 4\pi\mu e^{2b\phi} \right) . \quad (1.3)$$

In the case of $c = 1$ matter boson $c_L = 25$, $b = 1$, $Q = 2$ but we keep the general form of the Liouville action. We emphasize that the term in front of the Ricci scalar term comes from the anomaly of the measure. The remaining integral to perform is an integral over the conformal mode

ϕ known as the Liouville field and an integral over the moduli space parametrized by τ introduced previously.

$$M_h = \frac{\text{Metrics on } \mathcal{M}_h}{\text{Diffeo} \times \text{Weyl}}. \quad (1.4)$$

Hence, if modular invariance is satisfied, the partition function finally reads

$$\mathcal{Z} = \sum_{h \geq 0} (g_0)^{-\chi_h} \int d\tau \int [D\phi][DX][Db][Dc] e^{-(\mathcal{S}_\sigma + \mathcal{S}_{b,c} + \mathcal{S}_L)}, \quad (1.5)$$

where V_h is the volume of the moduli space of M_h . Let's focus on the Liouville sector for a moment. We can exploit that ϕ is integrated over to extract the μ dependence of the Liouville partition function. In fact, assuming the measure is invariant under $\phi \rightarrow \phi - \frac{\log(\mu)}{2b}$, one obtains

$$\mathcal{Z}_L^{(h)}(\mu) = \mu^{-\frac{Q_X h}{2b}} \mathcal{Z}_L^{(h)}(\mu = 1). \quad (1.6)$$

1.2 Liouville action and Target space interpretation

The different terms appearing in the Liouville+matter action have a meaning in terms of Target space fields. Let's recall the general form of the generalized non linear sigma model in presence of a dilaton $\Phi(Y)$, a Tachyon condensate $T(Y)$ and non trivial metric $G_{\mu\nu}(Y)$.

$$\mathcal{S} = \frac{1}{4\pi} \int d^2x \sqrt{\hat{g}} \left(T(Y) + \hat{\mathcal{R}}\Phi(Y) + g^{ab} G_{\mu\nu} \partial_a Y^\mu \partial_b Y^\nu \right). \quad (1.7)$$

We see by comparison to the Liouville + matter action that $Y = (X, \phi)$ and

$$T = 4\pi\mu e^{2b\phi}, \quad G_{\mu\nu} = \delta_{\mu\nu}, \quad \Phi = \Phi_0 + Q\phi. \quad (1.8)$$

This is important to note that the background (1.8) is solution of the one-loop vanishing of the β functions only for $\mu = 0$. For $\mu \neq 0$ the Liouville interaction should be interpreted as a tachyon-wall background rather than as a naive linear-dilaton solution of the free beta-function equations.

There is also an easy way that the potential plays the role of a Tachyon condensate. Indeed, the vertex operator reads

$$\mathcal{V}_T = e^{ik.Y} := e^{ikX + 2\alpha\phi}. \quad (1.9)$$

The marginality condition fixes $\Delta_X + \Delta_\phi = \Delta_X + \alpha(Q - \alpha) = 1$. Solving the previous condition with $\Delta_X = 0$ and selecting the state satisfying the Seiberg bound one obtains $\alpha = b$. We denote the integrated vertex operator as

$$V_T = \int d^2x \sqrt{\hat{g}} \mathcal{V}_T. \quad (1.10)$$

The Tachyon condensate results in an insertion of the infinite sum of $(\mu V_T)^n$

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-\mu)^n}{n!} \int d^2x_1 \sqrt{\hat{g}} \dots \int d^2x_n \sqrt{\hat{g}} e^{2b\phi(x_1)} \dots e^{2b\phi(x_n)}. \quad (1.11)$$

Remark that we effectively started with a sigma model with one boson and landed on a theory which has now two bosons X, ϕ . We say that from the non-decoupling of the conformal mode, a new dimension has emerged. This describes a inhomogeneous 2D space (ϕ, X) . Such inhomogeneity emerges in the ϕ direction due to the Liouville potential. The string coupling depends on the value of the dilaton and thus on the position in the ϕ direction as the dilaton and the Liouville conformal mode are related by (1.8). An observer sitting on the Liouville wall defined by the condition

$$4\pi\mu e^{2b\phi_*} = 1 \Rightarrow \Phi_* = \Phi_0 + Q\phi_* = \Phi_0 - Q \frac{\log(4\pi\mu)}{2b}. \quad (1.12)$$

observes the scattering of states with the string coupling $g_* = e^{\Phi_*}$. The amplitude of the process should be perturbatively described by a genus expansion in the string coupling at the position of the Liouville wall and this is exactly what the KPZ scaling relation gives (see (1.5), (1.6)).

1.3 Genus 0 Lagrangian

On the sphere $h = 0$, we choose a representant of the conformal class $\hat{g}_h$ such that the metric is flat on the complex plane $(z, \bar{z})$ except at one point which is taken at infinity. If one writes $ds^2 = 2dzd\bar{z}$, then the Liouville Lagrangian density on the sphere is

$$\begin{aligned} L_{\text{bulk}} &= \frac{1}{4\pi} \left(\partial_z \phi \partial_{\bar{z}} \phi + Q \hat{\mathcal{R}} \phi + \mu e^{2b\phi} \right) \\ &= \frac{1}{4\pi} \left(-\phi \partial_z \partial_{\bar{z}} \phi + Q \hat{\mathcal{R}} \phi + \mu e^{2b\phi} + \text{total derivative} \right). \end{aligned} \quad (1.13)$$

Choosing the representative of the conformal class which is flat on $\mathbb{C}$ trades the bulk curvature coupling for an asymptotic boundary condition at $z = \infty$. Thus the curvature term does not appear explicitly in the local Lagrangian density on the finite plane, but its effect is retained through the background-charge condition on ϕ at infinity.

$$\phi(z, \bar{z}) \underset{z \rightarrow \infty}{=} -2Q \log(z\bar{z}) + \mathcal{O}(1). \quad (1.14)$$

In fact, $\partial_z \partial_{\bar{z}} \log(z\bar{z}) = 2\pi \delta^2(z, \bar{z})$.

1.4 Wheeler De Witt constraint and physical states

Let a theory of gravity constructed as a tensor product $M = \mathcal{H}_L \otimes \mathcal{H}_X$. We take the matter theory to be c X bosons so that $c + c_L = 26$. We consider the theory at genus 0 on the Riemann sphere. The X states are thus described by closed string states. We consider a state that takes the following form

$$|\Psi\rangle = |\Psi_L\rangle \otimes |\Psi_X\rangle, \quad (1.15)$$

where both $|\Psi_L\rangle, |\Psi_X\rangle$ are primary states. Upon acting with Virasoro generators, such states span the hilbert space of the gravitational theory. Nevertheless, the Hilbert space is the truncation of this bigger space by the Wheeler-De Witt constraint

$$\left(L_0^{(\phi+X)} + \bar{L}_0^{(\phi+X)} - 2 \right) |\Psi\rangle = 0, \quad (1.16)$$

where $L_0^{(\phi+X)}$ is the Virasoro generator on the plane. This condition applied on the tensor product of primary states (1.15) imposes the marginality condition $\Delta_L + \Delta_X = 1$. To inspect the form of the Wheeler-De-Witt equation, we first note that there is no interaction between the matter theory and the Liouville by assumption so that the total Hamiltonian is a tensor product. We focus on the Liouville side which is the non-trivial side (PG: The other side tells you that $|\Psi_X\rangle$ is represented by a vertex operator in X-space, right ?). On genus 0, we can inspect the Wheeler De Witt equation by truncating to minisuperspace that is truncating to zero mode on the cylinder $\phi(\tau, \sigma) = \phi_0(\tau)$, $\sigma \in [0, 2\pi)$. The lagrangian density becomes a lagrangian

$$L_{\text{zero-mode}} = \frac{1}{2} \left((\partial_\tau \phi_0)^2 + 4\pi\mu e^{2b\phi_0} \right). \quad (1.17)$$

Applying canonical quantization and working in the ϕ_0 space, one immediatly finds the associated Schrodinger equation

$$\left[-\frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial \phi_0^2} + 2\pi\mu e^{2b\phi_0} \right] \Psi_L(\phi_0) = E_L^{(\text{cyl})} \Psi_L(\phi_0). \quad (1.18)$$

This equation should be equivalent to the Wheeler-De-Witt equation on the Liouville sector on the cylinder. We know $E_X^{\text{plane}} + E_L^{\text{plane}} = 2$ by the Wheeler-De-Witt equation so one might identified

$E_X^{\text{plane}} \rightarrow 2\Delta_X$, $E_L^{\text{plane}} \rightarrow 2\Delta_L$ but of course the identification between E_X, E_L and Δ_X, Δ_L is not one to one, one can shift $E_L^{\text{plane}} \rightarrow E_L^{\text{plane}} + a$, $E_X^{\text{plane}} \rightarrow E_X^{\text{plane}} - a$. The Schwarzian term has also the effect to shift the Virasoro generators

$$L_0^{\text{L,cylinder}} \rightarrow L_0^{\text{L,plane}} - \frac{c_L}{24}. \quad (1.19)$$

This fixes $E_L^{(\text{plane})} - E_L^{(\text{cyl})} = \frac{c_L}{12}$: the energy on the cylinder is shifted by the casimir energy $\frac{c_L}{12}$. Now, it appears to be convenient in the context of conformal bootstrap to parametrize

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta_L &= \frac{c_L - 1}{24} - P^2 = \frac{c_L - 1}{24} + p^2, \\ c_L &= 1 + 6Q^2. \end{aligned} \quad (1.20)$$

The Hilbert space of Liouville theory $\mathcal{H}_L$ known as the spectrum consists of diagonal operators with $p \in \mathbb{R}(+\epsilon)$ (in both spacelike and timelike case with an ϵ prescription). This means from the bootstrap perspective that the OPE rules are defined consistently with respect to the spectrum that is we have to sum over primaries with their momenta in the spectrum. If we take crossing symmetry as a requirement, we can't negotiate on that. Of course, this does not mean that we can not compute expectation values of operators for which their momentum is outside the spectrum. In practice, we can access such states and such quantities by analytic continuation. In order to identify p with the momentum of the asymptotic states far from the Liouville wall, it is convenient to write $E_L^{(\text{cyl})} = 2p^2 = 2\Delta_L - \frac{c}{12} + \frac{1}{12}$. Hence, the Wheeler-De-Witt equation on the Liouville sector yields

$$\left[-\frac{1}{2} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial \phi_0^2} + 2\pi\mu e^{2b\phi_0} - 2p^2 \right] \Psi_L(\phi_0) = 0. \quad (1.21)$$

Introducing the loop parameter $\ell = e^{b\phi_0}$, this becomes a modified Bessel equation

$$\ell^2 \frac{\partial^2}{\partial \ell^2} \Psi_L(\ell) + \ell \frac{\partial}{\partial \ell} \Psi_L(\ell) - \left(\frac{4\pi\mu}{b^2} \ell^2 - \frac{4p^2}{b^2} \right) \Psi_L(\ell) = 0. \quad (1.22)$$

States that decay in the strong coupling region $\phi_0 \rightarrow \infty$ correspond to Bessel-K functions (if $b \in \mathbb{R}!!$). So,

$$\Psi_L^{(p)}(\ell) \propto K_{\frac{2ip}{b}} \left(\frac{2\sqrt{\pi\mu}}{b} \ell \right). \quad (1.23)$$

As it should be, this is even in p so that Δ_L or (E_L) is indeed the correct physical parameter. By definition,

$$K_\nu(z) = \frac{I_\nu(z) - I_{-\nu}(z)}{\sin(\pi\nu)}, \quad (1.24)$$

and we have the asymptotics $I_\nu(z) \underset{z \rightarrow 0}{\sim} \left(\frac{z}{2}\right)^\nu$. We further define the reflection coefficient such that asymptotically in the weak coupling region

$$\Psi_L^{(p)}(\ell) \underset{\ell \rightarrow 0}{\propto} e^{2ip\phi_0} + R(p)e^{-2ip\phi_0}. \quad (1.25)$$

Due to the expression of K_ν and the asymptotic expansion of I_ν , we find

$$R(p) = -\sin\left(\pi \frac{2ip}{b}\right) \times \left(\frac{\pi\mu}{b^2}\right)^{2ip/b}. \quad (1.26)$$

We highlight that what we described here is crystal clear in the context of spacelike Liouville theory $c_L \geq 25 \Rightarrow b \in \mathbb{R}$. In the case $c_L \leq 1 \Rightarrow b \in i\mathbb{R}$, one has to analytically continue $\phi_0 \rightarrow i\phi_0$, $b \rightarrow -i\phi_0$ and the modified Bessel equation becomes a simple Bessel equation

$$\ell^2 \frac{\partial^2}{\partial \ell^2} \Psi_L(\ell) + \ell \frac{\partial}{\partial \ell} \Psi_L(\ell) + \left(\frac{4\pi\mu}{b^2} \ell^2 - \frac{4p^2}{b^2} \right) \Psi_L(\ell) = 0. \quad (1.27)$$

In such a case, it is still an ongoing puzzle on which boundary conditions fix the reflection coefficient.

Third quantized description in genus 0 minisuperspace We focus in the case $c_L \geq 25$. The closed string Liouville states that we discussed earlier should be viewed as wavefunction of the universe: precisely, they describe the amplitude of a universe to be nucleated from a vertex insertion of momentum p . We consider a second quantized description of the minisuperspace theory which was already a second quantized description therefore defining a so-called third quantized description. Remembering that the Hamiltonian acting on X is simply $\mathcal{H}_X = -\frac{\partial^2}{\partial X^2}$, the third quantized description should be

$$\mathcal{S}_{\text{third}} = \int d\phi dX \frac{1}{2} \left((\partial_\phi \Psi)^2 + (\partial_X \Psi)^2 + 4\pi\mu e^{2b\phi} \Psi^2 \right). \quad (1.28)$$

We shall view this as a massive field theory whose mass is expressed in terms of the string coupling $m^2 \sim g_s(\phi)$ which depends on the position in the ϕ space. In particular, in the weak coupling region, it describes a massless scalar field theory in 1+1d. We therefore immediatly obtain that the entanglement entropy of a cut $A = [\phi_1, \phi_2]$ in the weak coupling region is given by Cardy-Calabrese universal law

$$S_A = \frac{1}{3} \log \left(\frac{\phi_2 - \phi_1}{\epsilon_{\text{UV}}} \right) + c, \quad (1.29)$$

where c is a non universal constant and ϵ_{UV} is a UV-cutoff. From this strategy, this is hopeless to find the UV cutoff which was found by Hartnoll and Mazenc from the matrix model computation namely g_s . The physical cutoff they found arised because of the non-perturbative effects (so-called "wiggles" effects) provided by the matrix model. Those effects are actually tied to non-perturbative corrections to the Wheeler-De-Witt equation. Still, this computation tells you that Hartnoll-Mazenc results correspond to genus 0 approximation in the weakly coupled region + addition of non-perturbative results. Note that their computation was perform in the time of flight variable and the time of flight is one to one with the ϕ variable in the asymptotic region $\phi \sim \tau$. That's why we retrieve the same results. Still, this is conceptually interesting to see that the non perturbative effects of the corrected Wheeler-De-Witt equation can be related to the UV cutoff of the entanglement structure. You can actually think of extracting the non perturbative corrections from the entanglement structure. Typically, perturbative corrections to the Wheeler-De-Witt equations beyond genus 0 should come as powers of the string coupling. Actually note that for $c_m = 1$, $b = 1$, $Q = 2$, thus the cosmological constant term in Liouville theory can be written as $4\pi\mu e^{2b\phi} = 4\pi\mu g_s(\phi)$ in our convention. In general, the form of the corrected Wheeler-De-Witt equation should be

$$\left(-\partial_\phi^2 + 2p^2 + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n g_s^n + \text{non - perturbative effects} \right) \Psi_L^{(p)}(\phi) = 0. \quad (1.30)$$

An other interesting observation is that such theory can be mapped to a Klein-Gordon theory by the map $w = \exp[b(\phi + iX)]$ from which we obtain

$$\mathcal{S}_{\text{third}} = \int d^2w \left(2\partial_w \Psi \partial_{\bar{w}} \Psi + \frac{2\pi\mu}{b^2} \Psi^2 \right). \quad (1.31)$$

Curiously, it describes a massive scalar theory in 2D for which the mass is exactly determined by the string coupling at the position of the Liouville wall!

$$m^2 = g_s(\Phi_\star). \quad (1.32)$$

This correspondence is not anecdotic because it is well known that the problem of defining an Hilbert in canonical quantum gravity is somewhat similar to the one faced for a Klein-Gordon theory. In two dimensions, this correspondence is explicit. Unfortunately, this correspondence does not help you making progress in corrections to Cardy-Calabrese universal law. To see that one could think

of discretizing the ϕ -space and the density matrix associated to the cut $[\phi_1, \phi_2]$ correspond to a state where we trace over the boundary conditions outside the cut.

$$\rho_A = Z(\beta)^{-1} \sum_{\{\Psi(\phi)\}, \phi \in \bar{A}} \int_{\Psi(\phi, 0) = \Psi(\phi)}^{\Psi(\phi, \beta) = \Psi(\phi)} \dots \int_{\Psi(\phi_{\text{end}}, 0) = \Psi(\phi_{\text{end}})}^{\Psi(\phi_{\text{end}}, \beta) = \Psi(\phi_{\text{end}})} D\Psi(\phi \in A, X) e^{-S_{\text{third}}}. \quad (1.33)$$

This density matrix corresponds to a thermal density matrix and the pure state is obtained by taking $\beta \rightarrow 0$. When going from the ϕ, X -space to the w -space there is a non trivial jacobian arising from such a transformation. Clearly, this jacobian will spoil the fact that

$$S_{[\phi_1, \phi_2]}^{\text{EE}, \phi} \neq S_{[e^{\phi_1}, e^{\phi_2}]}^{\text{EE}, w}. \quad (1.34)$$

Adding a boundary to the manifold Consider now the possibility of adding a boundary and a non trivial interaction.

$$\mathcal{S}_L^{\text{bound.}} = \frac{1}{4\pi} \int d^2x \sqrt{\hat{g}_h} \left(\hat{g}_h^{\mu\nu} \partial_\mu \phi \partial_\nu \phi + Q \hat{\mathcal{R}} \phi + 4\pi \mu_e e^{2b\phi} \right) + \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{\partial M} ds \sqrt{\hat{h}} \hat{K} \phi + \mu_b \int_{\partial M} ds \sqrt{\hat{h}} e^{b\phi}. \quad (1.35)$$

h is the physical metric at the boundary and is related to the fiducial metric via $\sqrt{h} = e^{b\phi} \sqrt{\hat{h}}$ and $\hat{K}$ is the extrinsic curvature at the boundary. μ_b is the boundary cosmological constant but should also be understood as the tension/charge of the associated brane. The variational principle is well defined as long as it satisfies Dirichlet boundary conditions at the boundary. It can also satisfies Neumann boundary conditions if

$$n^\mu \partial_\mu \phi + \hat{K} + 2\pi b \mu_b = 0. \quad (1.36)$$

2 c=1 MQM

From the continuum formulation to a discretize model In two dimensions, the Einstein–Hilbert term is topological. Therefore, it is natural to replace the continuum sum over geometries by a sum over discretized random surfaces, such as triangulations, because the discretization can correctly organize the sum over topologies. This is a special feature of two dimensions. Of course, for the continuum limit to be well defined, it should not matter the way we discretize the surface. All the discretized versions should flow to the same continuum limit. This is a crucial feature of the continuum description. The argument showed in what follows should not be taken as a rigorous proof but rather as a motivation. For instance, we describe a two dimensional discretized connected and compact surface as a simplex of equilateral triangles, where at each vertex is attached a delta function of curvature depending on the number of triangles meeting at the vertex. The conical singularity is proportional to the deficit angle $\Delta = 2\pi - n\frac{\pi}{3}$. We may assume the following correspondence

$$\int Dg_{\mu\nu}^{(h)} \rightarrow \sum_{\Lambda_h}, \quad (2.1)$$

and then the integral over the matter field X in an sum over all the embedding on the real line at each vertex. Finally, denoting a the size of the sides of the triangles, we may assume the following dictionary

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{\mathcal{M}_h} d^2x \sqrt{g} g^{\mu\nu} \partial_\mu X \partial_\nu X &\rightarrow \sum_{\langle ij \rangle} (X_i - X_j)^2. \\ \int_{\mathcal{M}_h} d^2x \sqrt{g} \mu &\rightarrow \frac{\sqrt{3}}{4} a^2 \mu V. \end{aligned} \quad (2.2)$$

where V denotes the number of vertices. We call $\kappa = \exp\left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}a^2\mu\right)$. The partition function can thus be written as

$$\mathcal{Z} = \sum_{h \geq 0} (g_0)^{-\chi_h} \sum_{\Lambda_h} \kappa^V \prod_{i=1}^V \int dX_i \prod_{\langle ij \rangle} G(|X_i - X_j|). \quad (2.3)$$

We introduced $G(|X_i - X_j|) = \exp\left[-\left(\frac{X_i - X_j}{\sqrt{4\pi}}\right)^2\right]$. We may define the continuum limit as the double scaled limit where $a \rightarrow 0$ and the number of vertices to infinity so that to keep the physical area fixed. At the level of the partition function this is obtained by taking $a \rightarrow 0$ and κ to a critical value κ_c where the infinite sum shows a singular behavior. Progress can be made in evaluating such a sum by identifying it with the Feynman diagram expansion of a certain matrix model as it will be described in the following. Up to irrelevant prefactors we rewrite $\kappa = \kappa_c \exp\left(-\frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}a^2\mu\right)$.

The matrix model Here we start with the matrix quantum mechanics defined as a euclidean path-integral over $N \times N$ hermitian matrices M with cubic potential $U(M) = \text{Tr}\left[-\frac{M^2}{2} + \frac{M^3}{3!}\right]$. We also suppose that the action is defined on the compact slice of euclidean time $[-T, T]$. All in all, the partition function reads

$$\mathcal{Z}(\alpha, \beta) = \int_{M(-\beta/2)=M(\beta/2)} DM(\tau) e^{-\alpha \int_{-\beta/2}^{\beta/2} d\tau \text{Tr}\left[\frac{M^2}{2} + U(M)\right]}. \quad (2.4)$$

Dictionary with the discretized sigma model By rescaling of the matrix we can rewrite the partition function as up to an irrelevant prefactor¹

$$\mathcal{Z}(\alpha, \beta) = \int_{M(-\beta/2)=M(\beta/2)} DM(\tau) e^{-N \int_{-\beta/2}^{\beta/2} d\tau \text{Tr}\left[\frac{M^2}{2} - \frac{M^2}{2} + \tilde{\kappa} \frac{M^3}{3!}\right]}, \quad (2.5)$$

with $\tilde{\kappa} = \sqrt{\frac{N}{\alpha}}$. Sending $\beta \rightarrow \infty$, the partition function can be formally written as an infinite sum over all connected Feynman diagrams (t'Hooft expansion)

$$\lim_{\beta \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\log(\mathcal{Z})}{\beta} = \sum_{h=0}^{\infty} N^{2-2h} \sum_{\Lambda} \tilde{\kappa}^V \prod_{i=1}^V \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} d\tau_i \prod_{\langle ij \rangle} e^{-|\tau_i - \tau_j|}. \quad (2.6)$$

The first complain is that the link factor is different from the matrix model compared to the discretized gravitational model. The equality is not microscopic; it is a universality statement about the continuum limit. We may associate the following dictionary between the discretized gravitational model and the matrix model

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{\kappa} &= \sqrt{\frac{N}{\alpha}} = \kappa, \\ \frac{1}{N} &\sim g_0. \end{aligned} \quad (2.7)$$

From the discretized gravitational model, the continuum limit is obtained by sending the lattice spacing $a \rightarrow 0$. Equivalently, one tunes the bare lattice fugacity κ to its critical value κ_c , so that the number (V) of triangles diverges while the physical area is kept fixed.

From the matrix-model perspective, it would seem that, in order to define a theory with a finite string coupling, it is necessary to consider finite N . This naive expectation is false: in the

¹The Jacobian from the field rescaling is a local normalization of the matrix path-integral measure. It contributes only analytic, scheme-dependent terms to $\log(\mathcal{Z})$, and is discarded when extracting the double-scaled nonanalytic free energy.

continuum limit the string coupling $g_0 \sim 1/N$ becomes infinitely multiplicatively renormalized as $a \rightarrow 0$. Thus, if $N \rightarrow \infty$ is taken simulatenously with the worldsheet continuum limit, we might obtain a theory with finite string coupling. To reach finite κ_c while taking $N \rightarrow \infty$, $\alpha \rightarrow \infty$ which means that semi-classical WKB should be exact at the double scaled limit. While from the discretized gravitational limit, $a \rightarrow 0$ corresponds to the continuum limit, there is no such thing as the size of the triangles in the Feynman diagram expansion. The remaining question is thus: what is the counter part of the continuum limit from the matrix model perspective ? We will answer this question soon.

A useful quantity to define is the bare lattice cosmological constant Δ . It should be defined as the fugacity associated to the area so

$$\Delta = \kappa_c^2 - \kappa^2. \quad (2.8)$$

In the continuum limit, it is related to the physical cosmological constant by $\mu \sim \frac{\Delta}{a^2} < \infty$.

Solving the matrix model Also, the partition function can be interpreted as a thermal partition of inverse temperature and thus we can write

$$\mathcal{Z} = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}} [e^{-\beta \alpha H}] . \quad (2.9)$$

Here $\mathcal{H}$ denotes the Hilbert space of the theory and H corresponds to the haniltonian. Setting the inverse temperature to infinity, the partition function reduces to the vacuum amplitude

$$\mathcal{Z} \underset{\beta \rightarrow \infty}{\sim} e^{-\beta \alpha E_{\text{vac}}} . \quad (2.10)$$

In particular, one finds

$$\frac{\log(\mathcal{Z})}{\beta} \underset{\beta \rightarrow \infty}{\rightarrow} -\alpha E_{\text{vac}} . \quad (2.11)$$

The objective is to compute exactly such quantity.

Now, we wish to use the symmetry under conjugation by a unitary matrix to diagonalize the matrix M . If we consider such symmetry as a gauge symmetry, this crucially alters the boundary condition we shall impose since configurations of M related by a unitary belong to the same gauge orbit. We postpone such subtlety for latter and consider such symmetry as a global symmetry. We diagonalize $M = \Omega_M \Lambda_M \Omega_M^\dagger$, where Λ_M is the diagonal matrix of eigenvalues and Ω_M is a unitary matrix. **PG: What is the difference between using $SU(N)$ and $U(N)$? I guess you should add the identity as a generator?** . The measure is not invariant under such change of variables and one obtains

$$DM(\tau) = \prod_{I=1}^N D\lambda_I(\tau) D\Omega(t) \Delta^2(\lambda) , \quad (2.12)$$

$$\text{Tr} \left[\left(\frac{dM}{d\tau} \right)^2 \right] = \text{Tr} [\dot{\Lambda}^2] + \text{Tr} [\Lambda, \dot{\Omega}_M \Omega_M^\dagger]^2 .$$

Remark that $\frac{d\Omega_M}{d\tau} \Omega_M^\dagger$ is Lie-algebra valued. Let's suppose we use $SU(N)$ symmetry and not $U(N)$. We can thus decompose this Lie algebra quantity in terms of the generators of $SU(N)$. It has $N^2 - 1$ generators and the rank is $N - 1$. The Lie algebra consists in skew-hermitian traceless matrices. We take as generators of the Cartan diagonal imaginary matrices, and for the rest of the generators we consider antisymmetric real matrices $iT_{ij} = \delta_{ij} = -iT_{ji}$ and and matrices such that $iS_{ij} = i\delta_{ij} = iS_{ji}$. Hence,

$$\dot{\Omega}_M \Omega_M^\dagger = \frac{i}{\sqrt{2}} \sum_{I < J} \dot{\alpha}_{IJ} T_{IJ} + \dot{\beta}_{IJ} S_{IJ} + \sum_{I=1}^{N-1} \dot{\alpha}_I H_I . \quad (2.13)$$

We thus find

$$\text{Tr} [\dot{\mathbf{M}}^2] = \text{Tr} [\dot{\mathbf{A}}^2] + \sum_{I < J} (\lambda_I - \lambda_J)^2 (\dot{\alpha}_{IJ}^2 + \dot{\beta}_{IJ}^2). \quad (2.14)$$

Discarding the volume of $SU(N)$, the partition function reads

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Z} = & \int_{\lambda_I(-\beta/2)=\lambda_I(\beta/2)} \prod_{I=1}^N d\lambda_I(\tau) \Delta^2(\lambda(\tau)) \\ & \exp \left[-\alpha \int_{-\beta/2}^{\beta/2} d\tau \sum_{I=1}^N \frac{\dot{\lambda}_I^2}{2} + U(\lambda_I) + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{I < J} (\lambda_I - \lambda_J)^2 (\dot{\alpha}_{IJ}^2 + \dot{\beta}_{IJ}^2) \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (2.15)$$

Importantly, there is a remnant symmetry which is the permutation of the eigenvalues. The wavefunction should thus be symmetric under such permutation so we effectively describe bosonic particles. The important observation is that the system can be mapped to a system of N fermions. Remark first that the operator

$$\mathcal{O} = \sum_{I=1}^N \frac{\pi_I^2}{2} + U(\lambda_I) + \sum_{I < J} \frac{(\pi_{IJ}^2 + \tilde{\pi}_{IJ}^2)}{2(\lambda_I - \lambda_J)^2} \quad (2.16)$$

is not hermitian with respect to the non-flat measure. The π 's denote the momenta. But it is hermitian with respect to the flat measure. Nevertheless, the operator can be modified to produce a hermitian operator with respect to the non-flat measure. In fact, if we define $H = \Delta(\lambda)^{-1} \mathcal{O} \Delta(\lambda)$ then H is hermitian with respect to the non-flat measure i.e

$$\int \prod D\lambda_I \Delta^2(\lambda) \psi_1^* H \psi_2 = \int \prod D\lambda_I \Delta^2(\lambda) \psi_2 H \psi_1^*. \quad (2.17)$$

The eigenvalue problem can thus be written as

$$\left[\sum_I -\frac{1}{2\alpha^2 \Delta(\lambda)} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial \lambda_I^2} \Delta(\lambda) + U(\lambda_I) + \sum_{I < J} \frac{(\pi_{IJ}^2 + \tilde{\pi}_{IJ}^2)}{2(\lambda_I - \lambda_J)^2} \right] \psi(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N) = E \psi(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N). \quad (2.18)$$

Solving the eigenvalue problem yields an orthonormal basis with respect to the non-flat measure. Setting $\Psi = \psi \Delta(\lambda)$ produces a fermionic wavefunction. We can put in one to one correspondence to a theory of N free fermions. The lowest energy configurations do not interact as the interaction is manifestly positive. The eigenvalue problem for the fermions reads

$$\left[\sum_I -\frac{1}{2\alpha^2} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial \lambda_I^2} + U(\lambda_I) + \sum_{I < J} \frac{(\pi_{IJ}^2 + \tilde{\pi}_{IJ}^2)}{2(\lambda_I - \lambda_J)^2} \right] \Psi(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N) = E \Psi(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_N). \quad (2.19)$$

The ground state is obtained by filling the N first lowest energy levels

$$E_{\text{vac}} = \sum_{n=1}^N \epsilon_n. \quad (2.20)$$

In the limit where the inverse planck coupling α goes to infinity, we can resort to a semi-classical approximation using Bohr-Sommerfeld quantization condition

$$\int_{\lambda_-}^{\lambda_+} d\lambda \sqrt{2(\epsilon_n - U(\lambda))} = \frac{\pi n}{\alpha}. \quad (2.21)$$

In other words, in the semi-classical limit, the number of fermions is equal to the area of the phase space filled by the fermions

$$n = \int \frac{dp d\lambda \alpha}{2\pi} \Theta(\epsilon_n - \epsilon(p, \lambda)), \quad (2.22)$$

with $\epsilon(p, \lambda) = \frac{p^2}{2} + U(\lambda)$. In particular, denoting the level of the fermi sea as μ_F , we obtain

$$\int_{\lambda_-}^{\lambda_+} d\lambda \sqrt{2(\mu_F - U(\lambda))} = \frac{\pi N}{\alpha} = \pi \kappa^2(\mu_F). \quad (2.23)$$

$\lambda_{\pm}$ are the turning points of the classical orbits. Clearly, if one tunes μ_F close to the quadratic local maximum of the potential, $\kappa(\mu_F)$ develops a singular behavior. This is the counter part of the continuum limit from the matrix model perspective. It is obtained by magnifying the local quadratic maximum of the potential. Let us denote $\delta\mu_F = U_c - \mu_F$ where U_c is the local maximum of the potential at $\lambda = 0$. We also introduce the density of eigenvalues

$$\rho(\epsilon) = \frac{1}{\alpha} \sum \delta(\epsilon - \epsilon_i). \quad (2.24)$$

from which we also obtain

$$\kappa^2(\mu_F) = \int_0^{\mu_F} \rho(\epsilon) d\epsilon. \quad (2.25)$$

Differentiating wrt to $\delta\mu_F$, we obtain

$$\frac{\partial \Delta}{\partial \delta\mu_F} = \rho(\mu_F). \quad (2.26)$$

3 Conformal bootstrap of boundary Liouville theory

3.1 Notations

Central charge We parametrize the central charge as

$$c = 1 + 6Q^2, \quad Q = b + b^{-1}. \quad (3.1)$$

We do not assume anything particular range for the central charge. We want to obtain the shift equations as a functions of the momenta and the central charge.

Bulk conformal dimensions We parametrize the conformal dimension of bulk primary fields $V_P(z, \bar{z})$ as

$$\Delta = \frac{Q^2}{4} - P^2, \quad P \in i\mathbb{R}_+. \quad (3.2)$$

Boundary conformal dimension We work on the upper half-plane. Boundary primary fields are denoted as $\Psi_P(x)^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2}$ where P is the momentum and $\sigma_{1,2}$ corresponds to the boundary conditions on the two sides of the puncture (in principle the two boundary cosmological constants.) We do not assume any particular rules for σ_i (like FZZT boundary conditions).

Normalization We work with normalizations of the two point functions/three point functions which are symmetric. Precisely, we write

$$\begin{aligned} \langle V_{P_1}(0) V_{P_2}(1) \rangle &= B(P) (\delta(P_1 - P_2) + \delta(P_1 + P_2)), \\ \langle V_{P_1}(0) V_{P_2}(1) V_{P_3}(\infty) \rangle &= C(P_1, P_2, P_3), \\ \langle \Psi_{P_1}^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2}(0) \Psi_{P_2}^{\sigma_2 \sigma_1}(1) \rangle &= S_{P_1}^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2} (\delta(P_1 - P_2) + \delta(P_1 + P_2)), \\ \langle \Psi_{P_1}^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2}(0) \Psi_{P_2}^{\sigma_2 \sigma_3}(1) \Psi_{P_3}^{\sigma_3 \sigma_1}(\infty) \rangle &= C_{P_1, P_2, P_3}^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2 \sigma_3}, \end{aligned} \quad (3.3)$$

and also

$$\begin{aligned} \langle V_P(z, \bar{z}) \rangle &= \frac{U(P|\sigma)}{|z - \bar{z}|^{2\Delta}}, \\ \langle V_P(z, \bar{z}) \Psi_{P'}^{\sigma\sigma}(x) \rangle &= \frac{R(P; P'|\sigma)}{|z - \bar{z}|^{2\Delta - \Delta'} |z - x|^{2\Delta'}} \end{aligned} \quad (3.4)$$

3.2 Equations from the Teshner trick

We would like to write down all the possible equations one can get by insertion of appropriate degenerate fields. There are two things that we can do: either insert a bulk degenerate field $V_{(2,1)}(z, \bar{z})$ which always decouple. This would lead to second order differential equations. We can also insert $\Psi_{(3,1)}^{\sigma\sigma}(x)$ at the boundary. As was pointed out in the FZZT paper, $\Psi_{(2,1)}^{\sigma\sigma}(x)$ decouples only for peculiar values of σ . The reason is that introducing a boundary modifies the ward identities obeyed by the boundary fields as the stress tensor at the boundary is perturbed by a certain primary operator which corresponds to the "line operator" (see FZZT paper: **PG: Add the expression of the boundary stress tensor in my convention**). In the other hand, there is a comprehensive reason for which $\Psi_{(3,1)}^{\sigma\sigma}(x)$ always decouple. In fact, $V_{(2,1)}(z, \bar{z})$ always decouple and as $\Im(z) \rightarrow 0$, the primary bulk operator can be expanded in boundary operators. The expansion should be compatible with the doubling trick² and thus the fusion rule of $V_{(2,1)}(z)$ with itself (at $\bar{z}$) from which we obtain

$$V_{(2,1)} \times V_{(2,1)} = \Psi_{(1,1)}^{\sigma\sigma} + \Psi_{(3,1)}^{\sigma\sigma} \quad (3.5)$$

Three point function of boundary operators We first consider the possibility of inserting a the bulk degenerate field $V_{(2,1)}(z, \bar{z})$ in the boundary three point function with $\Re(z) \in (0, 1)$

$$\begin{aligned} & \langle \Psi_{P_1}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2}(0) V_{(2,1)}(z, \bar{z}) \Psi_{P_2}^{\sigma_2\sigma_3}(1) \Psi_{P_3}^{\sigma_3\sigma_1}(\infty) \rangle \\ &= \frac{R(P_{(2,1)}; P_{(1,1)} | \sigma_2)}{S_{P_{(1,1)}}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2}} \frac{C_{P_1, P_{(1,1)}, P_1}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_2} C_{P_1, P_2, P_3}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2\sigma_3}}{S_{P_1}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2}} \mathcal{G}_{(1,1)}^{(1)}(z, \bar{z}) \\ &+ \frac{R(P_{(2,1)}; P_{(3,1)} | \sigma_2)}{S_{P_{(3,1)}}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2}} \sum_{\eta \in \{-1, 0, 1\}} \frac{C_{P_1, P_{(3,1)}, P_1+\eta}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_2} C_{P_1+\eta b, P_2, P_3}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_3}}{S_{P_1+\eta b}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2}} \mathcal{G}_{(3,1)}^{(1,\eta)}(z, \bar{z}) \\ &= \frac{R(P_{(2,1)}; P_{(1,1)} | \sigma_2)}{S_{P_{(1,1)}}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2}} \frac{C_{P_{(1,1)}, P_2, P_2}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2\sigma_3} C_{P_1, P_2, P_3}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_3}}{S_{P_2}^{\sigma_2\sigma_3}} \mathcal{G}_{(1,1)}^{(2)}(z, \bar{z}) \\ &+ \frac{R(P_{(2,1)}; P_{(3,1)} | \sigma_2)}{S_{P_{(3,1)}}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2}} \sum_{\eta \in \{-1, 0, 1\}} \frac{C_{P_{(1,1)}, P_2, P_2+\eta b}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_2} C_{P_2+\eta b, P_2, P_3}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_3}}{S_{P_2+\eta b}^{\sigma_2\sigma_3}} \mathcal{G}_{(3,1)}^{(2,\eta)}(z, \bar{z}) \end{aligned} \quad (3.6)$$

The two equalities correspond to the different channel and this is the statement of crossing symmetry. The functions $\mathcal{G}$ correspond to the conformal blocks. I found the expansion **PG: To be checked!**

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{G}_{(1,1)}^{(i)}(z, \bar{z}) &= (z - \bar{z})^{\Delta'_{1,1} - 2\Delta_{(2,1)}} \left(\frac{z + \bar{z}}{2} \right)^0 + \dots \\ \mathcal{G}_{(3,1)}^{(i,\eta)}(z, \bar{z}) &= (z - \bar{z})^{\Delta'_{3,1} - 2\Delta_{(2,1)}} \left(\frac{z + \bar{z}}{2} \right)^{\Delta'_{i+\eta} - \Delta'_i - \Delta'_{(3,1)}} + \dots \end{aligned} \quad (3.7)$$

We denoted by Δ' the conformal dimensions of the boundary primaries. The leading behavior is crucial to map them to the basis of the differential equation arising from the null vector decoupling. This generalized BPZ equation will lead to a second order (**PG: PDE I guess, since they effectively have 5 point by the doubling trick...**).

Alternatively, we can insert $\Psi_{(3,1)}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2}(x)$ with $x \in (0, 1)$. One obtains

$$\begin{aligned} & \langle \Psi_{P_1}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2}(0) \Psi_{(3,1)}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2}(x) \Psi_{P_2}^{\sigma_2\sigma_3}(1) \Psi_{P_3}^{\sigma_3\sigma_1}(\infty) \rangle \\ &= \sum_{\eta \in \{-1, 0, 1\}} \frac{C_{P_1, P_{(3,1)}, P_1+\eta b}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_2} C_{P_1+\eta b, P_2, P_3}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_3}}{S_{P_1+\eta b}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2}} \mathcal{G}^{(1,\eta)}(x) \\ &= \sum_{\eta \in \{-1, 0, 1\}} \frac{C_{P_{(3,1)}, P_2, P_2+\eta b}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2\sigma_3} C_{P_1, P_2+\eta b, P_3}^{\sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_3}}{S_{P_2+\eta b}^{\sigma_2\sigma_3}} \mathcal{G}^{(2,\eta)}(x) \end{aligned} \quad (3.8)$$

²The origin of the doubling trick is encoded in the property of the stress tensor that satisfies $T(\bar{z}) = \bar{T}(z)$

The functions $\mathcal{G}$ are the conformal blocks. They have the following leading expansion

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{G}^{(1,\eta)}(x) &\underset{x \rightarrow 0}{\sim} x^{\Delta'_{1+\eta} - \Delta'_1 - \Delta'_{(3,1)}} \\ \mathcal{G}^{(2,\eta)}(x) &\underset{x \rightarrow 1}{\sim} (1-x)^{\Delta'_{2+\eta} - \Delta'_2 - \Delta'_{(3,1)}}\end{aligned}\tag{3.9}$$

Unlike the previous case, the decoupling of $\Psi_{(3,1)}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2}$ will produce a third order ODE (This is a ODE but we gain one order...). Let's emphasize this point: In bulk Liouville theory, the structure constants are such that they appropriate encode the connection formulae of a particular hypergeometric equation and also of higher order equations (arising from all the higher order degenerate fields decoupling). Boundary Liouville theory CFT data only encode the connection formulae of this third order equation (and those coming from fusing $\Psi_{(3,1)}^{\sigma_2\sigma_2}$ with itself) while the decoupling of the null vector arise for specific values of the boundary cosmological constants.

Two point function: 1 boundary operator with 1 bulk operator It seems more convenient in this case to insert a bulk degenerate field.

$$\begin{aligned}&\langle V_{(2,1)}(z, \bar{z}) V_P(z_1, \bar{z}_1) \Psi_P'^{\sigma\sigma}(x) \rangle \\&= \sum_{\epsilon=\pm} \frac{C(P, P_{(2,1)}, P + \frac{\epsilon b}{2})}{B(P + \frac{\epsilon b}{2})} R(P + \frac{\epsilon b}{2}; P' | \sigma) \mathcal{G}^{(\epsilon)}(z, z_1, x) \\&= \frac{R(P_{(2,1)}; P_{(3,1)} | \sigma)}{S_{P_{(3,1)}}^{\sigma\sigma}} \sum_{\eta \in \{-1, 0, 1\}} \frac{C_{P', P_{(3,1)}, P' + \eta b}^{\sigma\sigma\sigma}}{S_{P' + \eta b}^{\sigma\sigma}} R(P; P' + \eta b | \sigma) \mathcal{G}_{(3,1)}^{(\eta)}(z, z_1, x) \\&+ \frac{R(P_{(2,1)}; P_{(1,1)} | \sigma)}{S_{P_{(1,1)}}^{\sigma\sigma}} \frac{C_{P', P_{(1,1)}, P'}^{\sigma\sigma\sigma}}{S_{P'}^{\sigma\sigma}} R(P; P' | \sigma) \mathcal{G}_{(1,1)}(z, z_1, x).\end{aligned}\tag{3.10}$$

PG: I need to write the conformal blocks in terms of the invariants cross ratios (there should be two invariant cross ratios) The first equality corresponds to fusing the two bulk fields while the second corresponds to expanding the bulk field in terms of boundary operators.

1 point function We again insert a bulk degenerate field.

$$\begin{aligned}\langle V_{(2,1)}(z, \bar{z}) V_P(z, \bar{z}) \rangle &= \sum_{\epsilon=\pm} \frac{C_{P, P_{(2,1)}, P + \frac{\epsilon b}{2}}}{B(P + \frac{\epsilon b}{2})} U(P + \frac{\epsilon b}{2} | \sigma) \mathcal{G}^{(\epsilon)}(z, z_1) \\&= \frac{R(P_{(2,1)}; P_{(3,1)} | \sigma)}{S_{P_{(3,1)}}^{\sigma\sigma}} R(P; P_{(3,1)} | \sigma) \mathcal{G}_{(3,1)}(z, z_1) \\&+ \frac{R(P_{(2,1)}; P_{(1,1)} | \sigma)}{S_{P_{(1,1)}}^{\sigma\sigma}} R(P; P_{(1,1)} | \sigma) \mathcal{G}_{(1,1)}(z, z_1).\end{aligned}\tag{3.11}$$

The first channel correspond to fusing the two bulk fields together while the second one correspond to expanding the bulk field in terms of boundary operators.

3.3 BPZ equation

Bulk degenerate field The decoupling of the degenerate bulk field reads

$$\left\langle \left(L_{-2}^{(z)} + \frac{1}{b^2} L_{-1}^{2(z)} \right) V_{(2,1)}(z, \bar{z}) X \right\rangle = 0,\tag{3.12}$$

where X is a chain of fields inserted at different points (on the boundary or in the bulk).

Three point function of boundary operators We denote

$$\mathcal{V}_4(z, \bar{z}) = \langle \Psi_{P_1}^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2}(0) V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z}) \Psi_{P_2}^{\sigma_2 \sigma_3}(1) \Psi_{P_3}^{\sigma_3 \sigma_1}(\infty) \rangle . \quad (3.13)$$

The constraint reads

$$0 = \langle \Psi_{P_1}^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2}(0) \left(L_{-2}^{(z)} + \frac{1}{b^2} L_{-1}^{(z)} \right) V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z}) \Psi_{P_2}^{\sigma_2 \sigma_3}(1) \Psi_{P_3}^{\sigma_3 \sigma_1}(\infty) \rangle . \quad (3.14)$$

L_{-1} just yields ∂_z while $L_{-2}^{(z)} = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{w \sim z} \frac{dw T(w)}{w-z}$. The standard trick is to deform the contour to pick up the residues at the other poles. In the meantime, we want to avoid factor of ∂_{x_i} arising from the fact that

$$T(w) \Psi_P^{\sigma\sigma}(x_i) \sim \frac{\Delta'_i}{(w-x_i)^2} + \frac{\partial_{x_i}}{w-x_i} . \quad (3.15)$$

To do that we write

$$\frac{1}{w-z} = \frac{w(w-1)}{z(z-1)} \frac{1}{w-z} - \frac{w-z}{z(z-1)} - \frac{2z-1}{z(z-1)} . \quad (3.16)$$

This partial fraction decomposition has the benefit of removing one order of the pole at $w \sim 0, w \sim 1$ regarding the first term. The second term will correspond to the dilation operator L_0 while the last one will yield $L_{-1} = \partial_z$. Inserting this back to (3.14) produces

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = & \frac{1}{b^2} \partial_z^2 \mathcal{V}_4 - \frac{\Delta_{2,1}}{z(z-1)} \mathcal{V}_4 - \frac{2z-1}{z(z-1)} \partial_z \mathcal{V}_4 \\ & + \langle \Psi_{P_1}^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2}(0) \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{w \sim z} \frac{w(w-1)}{z(z-1)} \frac{T(w)}{w-z} V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z}) \Psi_{P_2}^{\sigma_2 \sigma_3}(1) \Psi_{P_3}^{\sigma_3 \sigma_1}(\infty) \rangle . \end{aligned} \quad (3.17)$$

We then deform the contour to pick up the poles at $0, 1, \infty$ and $\bar{z}$. It yields

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = & \frac{1}{b^2} \partial_z^2 \mathcal{V}_4 - \frac{\Delta_{2,1}}{z(z-1)} \mathcal{V}_4 - \frac{2z-1}{z(z-1)} \partial_z \mathcal{V}_4 - \frac{\Delta'_1}{z^2(z-1)} \mathcal{V}_4 + \frac{\Delta'_2}{z(1-z)^2} \mathcal{V}_4 - \frac{\Delta'_3}{z(1-z)} \mathcal{V}_4 \\ & - \langle \Psi_{P_1}^{\sigma_1 \sigma_2}(0) \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{w \sim \bar{z}} \frac{w(w-1)}{z(z-1)} \frac{T(w)}{w-z} V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z}) \Psi_{P_2}^{\sigma_2 \sigma_3}(1) \Psi_{P_3}^{\sigma_3 \sigma_1}(\infty) \rangle . \end{aligned} \quad (3.18)$$

As

$$\begin{aligned} T(w) V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z}) \sim & \frac{\Delta_{2,1} V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z})}{(w-z)^2} + \frac{\partial_z V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z})}{w-z} + \frac{\Delta_{2,1} V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z})}{(w-\bar{z})^2} + \frac{\partial_{\bar{z}} V_{\langle 2,1 \rangle}(z, \bar{z})}{w-\bar{z}} , \\ \frac{w(w-1)}{z(z-1)(w-z)} = & \frac{\bar{z}(\bar{z}-1)}{z(z-1)} \frac{1}{\bar{z}-z} + \frac{(2\bar{z}-1)(\bar{z}-z) - \bar{z}(\bar{z}-1)}{z(z-1)(\bar{z}-z)^2} \times (w-z) + o(w-z) , \end{aligned} \quad (3.19)$$

I finally obtain after picking up the pole at $\bar{z}$,

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = & \left[\frac{1}{b^2} \partial_z^2 - \frac{\Delta_{2,1}}{z(z-1)} - \frac{2z-1}{z(z-1)} \partial_z - \frac{\Delta'_1}{z^2(z-1)} + \frac{\Delta'_2}{z(1-z)^2} - \frac{\Delta'_3}{z(1-z)} \right. \\ & \left. + \frac{\bar{z}(\bar{z}-1) \partial_{\bar{z}}}{z(z-1)(z-\bar{z})} - \frac{(2\bar{z}-1)(\bar{z}-z) - \bar{z}(\bar{z}-1)}{z(z-1)(\bar{z}-z)^2} \Delta_{\langle 2,1 \rangle} \right] \mathcal{V}_4 \end{aligned} \quad (3.20)$$

which can be rewritten as

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = & \left[\frac{1}{b^2} \partial_z^2 - \frac{2\Delta_{2,1}}{z(z-1)} - \frac{2z-1}{z(z-1)} \partial_z - \frac{\Delta'_1}{z^2(z-1)} + \frac{\Delta'_2}{z(1-z)^2} - \frac{\Delta'_3}{z(1-z)} \right. \\ & \left. + \frac{\bar{z}(\bar{z}-1) \partial_{\bar{z}}}{z(z-1)(z-\bar{z})} - \frac{\Delta_{2,1}}{(z-\bar{z})^2} \right] \mathcal{V}_4 \end{aligned} \quad (3.21)$$

As expected, it yields a second order PDE. This equation should also be obeyed by all the conformal blocks cited above.

A Boundary states: Ishibashi states vs Cardy states

We first introduce Virasoro primary states. Highest-weight representations of the Virasoro algebra are generated from states $|V_P\rangle$ satisfying

$$L_0 |V_P\rangle = \Delta_P |V_P\rangle, \quad L_n |V_P\rangle = 0 \quad (n > 0), \quad \Delta_P = \frac{Q^2}{4} - P^2. \quad (\text{A.1})$$

We do not impose any normalization condition on the states $|V_P\rangle$.

On a conformal representative of a manifold with boundary, preserving one copy of the conformal symmetry requires the absence of momentum flow through the boundary,

$$n_\mu T^{\mu\nu} = 0. \quad (\text{A.2})$$

At the quantum level, this condition translates into the gluing condition

$$(L_n - \bar{L}_{-n}) |B\rangle = 0, \quad n \in \mathbb{Z}, \quad (\text{A.3})$$

where the boundary state $|B\rangle$ is viewed as a closed-string state.

For each Virasoro representation generated by a primary state $|V_P\rangle$, there exists an Ishibashi state, denoted by $|P\rangle$, which solves the gluing condition. It can be written formally as

$$|P\rangle = \sum_{N \geq 0} \sum_{I, J \in \mathcal{P}_N} \left(S^{(N)} \right)_{IJ}^{-1} L_{-I} |V_P\rangle \otimes \overline{L_{-J} |V_P\rangle}, \quad (\text{A.4})$$

where $\mathcal{P}_N$ denotes the set of partitions of the level N , $L_{-I} = L_{-i_1} \cdots L_{-i_k}$ for $I = (i_1, \dots, i_k)$ with $\sum_a i_a = N$, and $S^{(N)}$ is the Shapovalov matrix of Virasoro descendants at level N . In general, physical boundary states also called Cardy states need not to be Ishibashi states. Physical boundary states $|s_1\rangle, |s_2\rangle$ satisfy the open/close string duality Cardy condition. Let an annulus of unit width for which the circle has length β . Then

$$\begin{aligned} Z_{s_1 s_2}(\beta) &= \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{\text{open}}} [e^{-\beta H_{s_1 s_2}}] = \sum_{\mathbf{h}} n_{\mathbf{h}}^{s_1 s_2} \chi_{\mathbf{h}}(\beta) \\ &= \langle s_1 | e^{-H/\beta} | s_2 \rangle. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A.5})$$

This condition should be understood as determining $n_{\mathbf{h}}^{s_1 s_2}$.